Google Developer Group
Bandung Institute of Technology



Stack 2026

Solution Technology Arena for Coding & Knowledge

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About Us

General Overview

STACK 2026 by GDGoC ITB is a student hackathon that brings a problem, a team, and a working solution into one journey. STACK stands for Solution Technology Arena for Coding & Knowledge. Participants turn an original idea into a prototype through a preliminary round, a semifinal round, and a Final Day.

Event Theme

This year, we are excited to introduce our theme:

"Agent of the Ocean: Vibing Beyond the Code"

Imagine arriving at the edge of an ocean, where the horizon invites you to explore. You do not need to know every route before you begin. You need curiosity, a team willing to learn, and the courage to test an idea against a real problem. At STACK, every participant can be an agent of change, carrying that spirit of exploration into technology.

Vibing Beyond the Code celebrates the energy of building together. Beyond writing code, teams must understand users, make thoughtful design decisions, test their assumptions, and explain why their solution matters. Ocean is the narrative setting of this edition. **Projects do not have to address marine issues, and an AI agent is not required.**

Challenge Cases

Each team must select one primary case and define a specific problem within it. The proposed solution should identify its intended users, explain their needs, and demonstrate an achievable benefit.

The examples below are starting points. Teams may explore other problems within the selected case.

Case 1: Smarter Campus and Learning

"How might we help students learn, collaborate, and access campus opportunities more effectively?"

This case focuses on digital solutions that reduce barriers in the student journey. Intended users may include students, student organizations, peer mentors, and campus service users.

Possible problems include:

- Fragmented scholarship and opportunity information.
- Learning materials that are difficult to access.
- Difficulty finding suitable study partners.
- Inefficient booking of shared campus facilities.

Teams should demonstrate a clear user journey, a working core interaction, and a measurable or testable benefit, such as time saved, improved task completion, or better accessibility.

Case 2: Stronger Communities and Everyday Services

"How might we make everyday services easier to access and manage for communities and small organizations?"

This case focuses on improving a real service or operational workflow. Intended users may include local communities, small businesses, volunteers, and service providers.

Possible problems include:

- Unclear service queues.
- Manual inventory records.
- Uncoordinated volunteer schedules.
- Difficulty tracking community reports and service requests.

Teams should demonstrate a working service flow, appropriate handling of user data, and an achievable improvement, such as fewer errors, faster responses, or easier access to services.

Prizes and Registration Fee

Prizes

All participants who qualify for and compete in the Semifinal Phase will receive a certificate of participation issued by GDGoC ITB, part of Google Developer Groups' global community of developers and innovators. Celebrate your achievement with a meaningful addition to your portfolio that reflects your creativity, collaboration, and commitment to solving real problems.

Participants who advance to and compete in the Final Phase will also receive a finalist certificate recognizing their achievement as one of STACK 2026's Top 10 teams.

Total Prize Pool: ±Rp5.000.000

Winning teams will receive cash prizes from the total prize pool.

Registration Fee

Initial registration and the preliminary phase are completely free of charge (**FREE**). However, **teams that qualify for the semifinals** are required to pay a registration fee per team to proceed to the **semifinal phase** later. Exact details regarding the fee amount and payment deadline will be announced alongside the semifinal announcement.

Timeline

Dates	Stage	Participant activity
20 Oct 2026 - 7 Nov 2026 (EXTENDED from 5 Nov!!!)	Free registration	Register a team and obtain official instructions.
10 Nov 2026	Preliminary submission	Submit an abstract and individual twibbon evidence.
18 Nov 2026	Semifinal announcement	Check results and continuation instructions.
30 Nov 2026	Semifinal submission	Submit a proposal and one team video.
7 Dec 2026	Top 10 announcement	Confirm participation in Final Day.
7-16 Dec 2026	Product improvement	Develop the selected prototype and prepare a completion plan.
16 Dec 2026	Final Day	Complete the prototype, submit product and deck, then present.

All deadlines are at **23:59 WIB** (UTC+7) on the stated date. All scheduled dates on this timeline might be changed later. Kindly monitor our Instagram @gdgocitb for further announcements.

Terms and Conditions

Participant Eligibility

1. Participants must be active university students and Indonesian citizens (WNI). Students enrolled in overseas universities are eligible to participate, provided they hold Indonesian citizenship. (Note: The final round is expected to take place in person in Bandung, Indonesia, so participants from overseas universities should keep this requirement in mind.)
2. Each participant may register in only one team.
3. Each team may submit one original project.
4. Each team must consist of 3-4 members and appoint a leader as its official contact.
5. Each team member can come from different universities.
6. Participants must provide accurate identity and institution information. The committee may verify student status.
7. Committee members and individuals directly involved in setting or judging the competition may not compete.
8. Team membership becomes fixed after registration closes. Exceptional changes require committee approval before the affected round begins.
9. Participants must attend any briefings announced by the committee and comply with official competition announcements.
10. Every team member must complete the registration promotion requirements: upload the official twibbon to their own Instagram account, share the official STACK 2026 broadcast message in three different group chats, upload the official STACK 2026 poster to their own Instagram account, and follow the official GDGoC ITB Instagram account (@gdgocitb). These requirements apply individually to every member, including the team leader.

General Competition Rules

1. English is the official language of STACK 2026. All written submissions, videos, presentations, and pitching sessions must be in English.

2. Teams must choose one primary case from the given cases, and develop the same project throughout the competition.
3. Teams must follow the requirements and deadlines for their current stage.
4. Participants must be able to explain their contributions, design decisions, and implementation.
5. Research findings, user numbers, test results, and development progress must be reported accurately.
6. Planned features must not be represented as completed functionality.
7. Simulated data, mockups, and unfinished features must be clearly identified.
8. Teams must maintain access to their submissions throughout the relevant evaluation period.
9. Preliminary and semifinal activities are conducted through online submissions. The Final Day arrangement will follow the confirmed official announcement.

Originality and Third-Party Resources

The project must be newly created for STACK 2026. Existing projects, including previous competition entries, may not be resubmitted, renamed, or repackaged.

Teams are expected to continue developing the same original STACK project from the Preliminary Phase through the Final Phase.

Public frameworks, libraries, APIs, datasets, and general-purpose starter templates may be used with appropriate attribution and permissions. However, the substantive solution must be developed by the registered team members. A ready-made application may not be presented as the team's original work.

Each semifinalist team must attach a signed Declaration of Originality to its proposal (template will be given later).

Technology and AI Usage

1. Teams may develop web, mobile, desktop, or other demonstrable digital products.
2. No particular programming language, framework, cloud provider, or technology vendor is required.

3. AI, AI agents, AI coding assistants, vibe coding, and Google technologies are optional.
4. Material AI assistance must be disclosed in the proposal and product README, including the tool and its role.
5. Teams remain responsible for understanding, testing, and correcting their work.
6. AI usage does not justify plagiarism, fabricated evidence, or undisclosed third-party contributions.
7. Participants must protect personal information, API keys, credentials, and other sensitive data.
8. Demonstrations should use appropriately authorized or synthetic data.
9. Judges assess the solution and its implementation. Using a particular tool, paid service, or AI model does not automatically earn additional points.

Preliminary Phase

Overview and Deliverables

The Preliminary Phase evaluates the problem and proposed solution.

Each team submits only:

- One abstract.
- Evidence that every team member has uploaded the official twibbon to their own Instagram account.

A proposal, video, prototype, presentation deck, or signed originality declaration is **not required** at this stage.

Abstract Requirements

The abstract must:

1. The official abstract guidelines and example are available at https://s.id/AbstractMaterialSTACK2026
2. Contain 300-500 words
3. Be submitted as a PDF without a separate cover.
4. State the team name, project title, selected case, and member names.
5. Be written in English.

6. Explain the problem, intended users, and supporting observations or evidence.
7. Describe the proposed solution and core user flow.
8. Identify planned technologies.
9. Explain the expected benefit and a feasible development plan.

Source acknowledgments may be placed after the abstract and excluded from the word count.

Twibbon Requirements

1. Every member must upload one official twibbon to their own Instagram feed as part of the registration requirements.
2. The official twibbon template and caption are available at https://s.id/RegistrationMaterialsSTACK2026 .
3. Participants must use the official template and follow the caption and tagging instructions.
4. Evidence must include the member's name, Instagram handle, post URL, and a screenshot showing the post and account identity.
5. All members' twibbon evidence must be consolidated into one PDF for the Preliminary Phase submission. The same posts and screenshots used for registration may be reused.
6. Posts must remain verifiable throughout preliminary evaluation.
7. Twibbon compliance is an administrative requirement. Likes, views, and follower counts do not contribute to the score.

Semifinal Phase

Overview and Deliverables

Semifinalists develop their selected ideas into:

1. A detailed proposal, including the signed originality declaration as an appendix.
2. One explanatory video per team.

Proposal Requirements

The proposal must be submitted as a PDF containing a maximum of 10 content pages, excluding the cover, references, and signed declaration.

There are no templates for the proposal. The proposal must be written in English. Suggested formatting is A4 paper, a readable 11-12 pt font, 1.15 line spacing, and 2.5 cm margins.

The proposal must cover:

Section	Required Content
Project and Team Identity	Project title, team name, selected case, members, and their roles.
Problem and User Analysis	Problem context, target users, supporting evidence, and existing alternatives.
Proposed Solution	Value offered, scope, main user journey, and distinguishing features.
Technical Design	Core features, architecture or system flow, technologies, and data sources.
Development Plan	Milestones, current progress, member contributions, and planned Final Day tasks.
Validation and Impact	Validation plan or actual early tests, expected benefit, risks, privacy, and sustainability.
References and Declaration	Third-party resources, material AI assistance, references, and the signed originality declaration.

A separate lean canvas or business plan is not required.

Video Requirements

1. Each team submits one video with a duration no longer than 2 minutes.
2. The video must have clear audio and a minimum resolution of 1080p.
3. Narration or subtitles must be understandable in English.

4. The video must introduce the team, explain the problem and solution, and show a user flow or early prototype.
5. Teams must state what has been completed and what remains to be developed.
6. A finished product is not required at this stage.

Final Phase

General Mechanism

The Top 10 teams arrive at Final Day with partially developed prototypes and complete them during the build session.

Teams continue their original STACK projects. They do not restart from empty repositories, and they must retain meaningful development work for Final Day.

Final Day is tentatively planned to take place offline in Bandung. If this arrangement is confirmed, participants will be responsible for their transportation, accommodation, and other personal expenses.

Preparation Before Final Day

1. Develop a functional starting point during the product improvement period.
2. Prepare the architecture, main screens, data flow, and sufficient implementation to demonstrate the current state.
3. Record completed and unfinished features.
4. Identify 2-3 substantive tasks for Final Day, such as integrating a core flow, implementing a missing feature, or resolving a significant usability problem.
5. Prepare a repository, setup instructions, and demonstration access.
6. Share credentials safely and avoid committing secrets to the repository.
7. Prepare a local demonstration fallback where possible.
8. Bring their own laptop, charger, and required demonstration devices or adapters.
9. Venue facilities will be announced later.

Build Session

1. Teams check in and record their starting repository commit or equivalent artifact version.
2. Teams submit or show their current feature list and completion plan.
3. Development proceeds within the announced session.
4. The committee may conduct progress checks and ask members to explain their contributions.
5. At the cutoff, teams record the final version and summarize session changes in the product README.
6. Teams stop modifying the version submitted for judging.
7. Teams submit their product package and deck before proceeding to pitching.

Product Requirements

1. A working prototype with at least one complete core user flow.
2. A repository link or approved source-code archive accessible to judges.
3. Setup instructions, dependencies, and the supported environment.
4. Demo access or account instructions.
5. References to third-party resources and material AI assistance.
6. Known limitations and identification of simulated or unfinished functionality.
7. The starting and final versions, Final Day changes, and member contributions.

Web products must provide a reachable deployment or reliable local setup. Mobile and desktop products must provide an installable build or documented run instructions. Other platforms must include clear demonstration instructions.

Presentation Deck

The presentation deck must be no longer than 15 slides (excluding the cover and any appendix), submitted as a PDF. The deck should cover the team, selected case, problem and evidence, users, proposed solution, demonstration flow, technical approach, validation, impact, Final Day improvements, and next steps.

Pitching Session

The proposed allocation is 10 minutes for presentation & live demonstration and 10 minutes for questions and answers. Judges may direct technical questions to any member. Teams must demonstrate the main workflow, explain implementation decisions, and clearly identify mockups or simulated behavior.

Submission and Access Requirements

1. Use the same team-name identifier throughout the competition.
2. Submit through the official form or platform for the relevant stage.
3. Check filenames, formats, permissions, and deadlines before submission.
4. Maintain access throughout the relevant evaluation period.
5. Retain the submission receipt and a backup of the exact submitted version.
6. Report access problems promptly with supporting evidence. Extensions are not automatic. Late submissions will not be evaluated.

Conduct, Verification, and Sanctions

Participants must not:

1. Copy another team's work or outsource substantive development.
2. Fabricate student identity, research evidence, test results, or progress records.
3. Produce another team's competition submission.
4. Harass participants, judges, or committee members.
5. Disrupt competition systems or interfere with other teams.

The committee may request development history, explanations, or demonstrations to verify originality and compliance. Teams will have an opportunity to clarify allegations before sanctions are determined.

Depending on the violation, sanctions may include correction of administrative issues, a communicated score adjustment, or disqualification for serious misconduct.

Ownership and Rule Updates

Project ownership remains with its creators. Any permission for event publicity is limited to agreed public materials and does not transfer ownership.

Changes may occur to this handbook in the future. All updates will be announced via our official channels, such as Instagram or our website.

Evaluation Criteria

Preliminary Phase

Criterion	Description	Weight
Problem Clarity	Specific users, a real need, and relevant supporting evidence.	30%
Fit to the Selected Case	Clear connection between the problem, solution, and chosen case.	20%
Value and Originality	Usefulness and distinction from existing alternatives.	25%
Feasibility	Realistic scope, technology, and development plan.	15%
Abstract Clarity	Coherent explanation and compliance with the required format.	10%
Total		100%

Semifinal Phase

Criterion	Description	Weight
Problem Understanding	Supporting evidence, user needs, and analysis of alternatives.	25%
Solution Design	Core workflow, value, originality, and case alignment.	25%
Technical Feasibility	Architecture, technology choices, data, and achievable scope.	20%
Execution and Validation	Milestones, roles, testing, risks, and Final Day plan.	20%
Communication	Clear and consistent	10%

	proposal and video that accurately describe progress.	
Total		100%

Final Phase

Criterion	Description	Weight
Functionality and Reliability	The core flow works consistently in the main usage scenario.	30%
Problem Fit and Usefulness	The product addresses a demonstrated need within the chosen case.	20%
Technical Quality	Appropriate architecture, maintainability, data handling, and implementation choices.	15%
Usability and Accessibility	Understandable interactions, clear feedback, and consideration of intended users.	10%
Validation and Impact	Credible tests, honest limitations, and measurable or testable benefits.	10%
Final Day Execution	Substantive, traceable progress against the declared plan.	10%
Pitch and Technical Understanding	Clear demonstration and convincing team answers.	5%
Total		100%

Registration

Initial Registration

1. Form a team consisting of 3-4 members and appoint a leader.
2. Choose one primary case and prepare a project working title.
3. Access the official registration form at:
   https://gdgoncampusitb.com/hackathon
4. Ensure every team member completes all four promotion requirements below before submitting the registration form:

Requirement	Instructions	Official Materials
Twibbon Upload	Upload the official twibbon to your own Instagram feed using the provided template and caption.	https://s.id/RegistrationMaterialsSTACK2026
Poster Upload	Upload the official STACK 2026 poster to your own Instagram account and follow the provided posting instructions.	https://s.id/RegistrationMaterialsSTACK2026
Broadcast Sharing	Share the official STACK 2026 broadcast message in three different group chats per person.	https://s.id/RegistrationMaterialsSTACK2026
Instagram Account	Every team member must follow the GDGoC ITB official Instagram account.	https://instagram.com/gdgocitb

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